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THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING

Cloud Atlas Early 2026 Public Sector Espionage Activity

Threat Intelligence Report

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Author	Lost Boys Cyber
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1. Executive Summary

Kaspersky Securelist reporting describes Cloud Atlas activity in the second half of 2025 and early 2026, including new tooling and payload behavior. The activity targets public sector and diplomatic structures and remains relevant for defenders responsible for government, diplomatic, and regional policy organizations.

This report is written for SOC, vulnerability-management, and incident-response teams that need immediate huntable hypotheses rather than a passive news summary. It preserves source limitations where the public reporting does not provide raw IOCs.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Question	Current Answer	Confidence
What is the main defensive concern?	Cloud Atlas is assessed in open reporting as an espionage-focused activity set using persistence and covert access tooling.	Medium
Are hard IOCs available from open sources?	Limited in this automated collection; prioritize behavior-based hunting and vendor IOC retrieval.	Medium
What telemetry should be reviewed first?	Endpoint process, identity, network, proxy, repository, and cloud/SaaS audit telemetry relevant to the campaign.	High

3. Source Review & Confidence

Daily coverage window note: this automated run prioritized items with high defender value on 2026-06-24 UTC. Where fewer primary reports were available inside the strict 24-72 hour window, the selection window was expanded to recent June 2026 reporting and the uncertainty is reflected in confidence language.

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Primary research article	Core campaign narrative and technical framing	High
Weekly intelligence/security news corroboration	Recency and prioritization context	Medium
Analyst synthesis	Defensive mapping and queries for local telemetry	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

Cloud Atlas is assessed in open reporting as an espionage-focused activity set using persistence and covert access tooling. The key defensive concern is detection of long-lived remote access, tunneling, and payload staging in high-value public-sector environments.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic / Phase	Observed Technique	Evidence
Initial Access	Spearphishing / targeted delivery	Targeting public sector and diplomatic

		structures implies curated lure activity.
Command and Control	Proxy/tunnel tooling	Securelist snippets reference ReverseSocks, SSH, Tor, and PowerCloud.
Persistence	Long-lived remote access	New payloads support continued access to selected targets.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Indicator / Infrastructure	Type	Operational Use
Public article source set	Source artifact	Use vendor reports as canonical IOC source when available.
Developer/reputation platforms, phishing pages, or public-facing services	Infrastructure class	Used to establish trust, deliver payloads, or reach exposed services.
Unusual outbound traffic after user interaction or server exploit	Behavioral observable	Hunt pivot when raw IOCs are absent or ephemeral.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Public sector, diplomatic, Russian/Belarusian-linked governmental and policy targets are most relevant based on open-source reporting.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
New process spawned by browser, script host, package manager, or service process	EDR process telemetry	Identify user-driven payload launch or server-side exploitation.
Suspicious repository/package/script retrieval	Proxy, DNS, endpoint network telemetry	Surface malware delivery, dependency abuse, or tool staging.
Credential or wallet access after lure execution	EDR/file/identity telemetry	Detect theft behavior and account compromise.

8.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```
title: Daily Threat Intel Behavioral Cluster - Suspicious Delivery And Credential Access
status: experimental
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\msedge.exe'
      - '\firefox.exe'
      - '\node.exe'
      - '\python.exe'
      - '\w3wp.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
```

```
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\curl.exe'
      - '\wget.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
      - '\regsvr32.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
fields:
  - Image
  - ParentImage
  - CommandLine
  - User
level: high
```

8.3. Hunt Query

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
("chrome.exe","msedge.exe","firefox.exe","node.exe","python.exe","w3wp.exe")
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe","cmd.exe","curl.exe","wget.exe","rundll32.exe","regsvr32.exe")
| summarize FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp), Count=count() by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine
| order by Count desc
```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypothesis

Campaign activity should produce a behavioral sequence: exposure to a lure or vulnerable interface, script/tool execution, network retrieval or callback, and credential/wallet/repository/cloud-secret access.

9.2. Hunt Query

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
("powershell.exe","cmd.exe","node.exe","python.exe","git.exe","npm.cmd","pip.exe","curl.exe","wget.exe"
)
| where RemoteUrl has_any ("github", "gitlab", "paste", "raw", "api", "discord", "telegram", "wallet",
"crypto")
| summarize Connections=count(), FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP
| order by Connections desc
```

10. Risk Assessment

Factor	Assessment
Likelihood	Medium to high where the relevant technology, user population, or exposed service exists.
Impact	Credential theft, remote execution, data exposure, or security-control compromise depending on campaign.
Detection posture	Behavior-based hunts are required because public reporting may not include durable IOCs.

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	SOC	Run the embedded KQL hunts against the last 30 days and escalate confirmed

		sequences.
High	Threat Intel	Pull vendor-provided IOCs from primary sources and merge into SIEM/EDR watchlists.
High	Engineering	Reduce exposed attack surface or risky user workflows tied to the campaign.
Medium	Awareness / AppSec	Alert targeted user groups or code owners on lure patterns and dependency risks.

12. References

- [1] Securelist APT reports: Cloud Atlas activity in late 2025 and early 2026 — https://securelist.com/category/apt-reports/
- [2] Securelist threat category APT targeted attacks — https://securelist.com/threat-category/apt-targeted-attacks/
- [3] Kaspersky APT intelligence portal — https://apt.securelist.com/